

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the headings remain the same for the 51st General Service Conference Evaluation Form. The committee suggested that the Conference Evaluation Form be printed on brightly colored paper and placed in the front of the Conference Manual, and that frequent announcements to fill out the form and hand it in be made throughout the Conference week.
- The committee discussed the Spanish Translations and Remote Communities meetings that were held prior to the 50th General Service Conference and suggested that a Presentation/Discussion topic on Spanish Translations be included on the agenda of the 51st General Service Conference.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a letter and form to be sent out annually in August to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topic.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and made a minor change.
- The existing Archives policy on anonymity was reviewed and discussed at length. The committee was satisfied that the trustees' committee's discussion on this topic significantly reflected the views of the Fellowship and accepted the trustees' committee's assurance that the topic would continue to receive the attention it deserves.
- A progress report was presented on the Archives Kit. The committee members expressed their appreciation for the ideas and suggestions they received from a number of areas. Several Area Archives Handbooks were consulted for this work. The committee was pleased with the suggested contents of the draft. Since the Kit format provides flexibility that allows for updates and potential additions, the committee encouraged the trustees' Archives Committee to complete and make the new Kit available as soon as possible.
- The committee discussed the roles of area archivists, archives chairs, and collectors and suggested that the new Archives Kit include a discussion of these roles.
- After brief discussion regarding an archives service piece pamphlet the sense of meeting was to encourage the trustees' Archives Committee to continue development.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed ways of providing A.A. information to professionals and made the following suggestions:

The committee agreed with the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities' consensus that one-on-one sharing was a more successful way than providing A.A. literature alone in helping professionals feel competent in working with those afflicted with alcoholism.

The committee suggested that Information on Alcoholics Anonymous (F-2) along with profession-specific literature be used to supplement one-on-one contact with professionals.

The committee suggested that A.A. members offer to accompany professionals to open A.A. meetings as a way of sharing hope with the professional community.

- The committee reviewed contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

That the sentence on page 10 of the C.P.C. Workbook which reads, "There are no requirements for A.A. membership" be deleted.

That the initial paragraph on page 18 of the C.P.C. Workbook, under the heading Basic Guidelines on C.P.C. Presentations, be changed to read, "Here are two suggested formats for presentations."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook from Conference-approved literature to service material and took no action.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the 1988 Advisory Action #2 concerning using literature prices as the primary mechanism to adjust the Reserve Fund and requests the trustees' Finance Committee to prepare examples of a floating cap plan for the 2001 Conference Finance Committee. This may include such items as historical data, average number of months of operating expenses covered by the Prudent Reserve over a period of years, methods used to monitor the Reserve Fund, and any other items the trustees' Finance Committee deems appropriate. This is requested to help study alternatives to price reductions which apparently sends a mixed message to the Fellowship.
- The committee discussed increasing the delegate fees, and determined no change be made at this time, but in the spirit of self-support encourages areas to make a contribution, over and above the suggested figure, if possible, to defray the average cost per delegate.
- After a discussion the committee noted the use of visual aids is very helpful in generating interest in service pieces and correspondence, such as the quarterly mailing, and suggests they continue to be used. Also, members are encouraged to use tools such as Birthday Plan, Memoriam Contributions and Gratitude Month.
- In expectation of continuing discussion of Self-Support, the committee invites areas to share their experience in Self-Support with the committee.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the five-year history of La Viña. Being mindful of the demonstrated effectiveness of La Viña and the strong support for it expressed by the A.A. membership as a whole, and considering its spiritual benefits as a Twelfth Step tool, the committee wishes to express strong support for its continued publication.

- The committee discussed the advisability of producing the Grapevine magazine on tape and decided this is not a viable project because of the high cost and lack of expressed need.
- The committee discussed returning the About Alcoholism section (the "gray pages") to the Grapevine and felt that no action was necessary. The committee saw no need or desire in the Fellowship for the section. Information from the alcoholism field does not promote A.A.'s primary purpose and is readily available elsewhere.
- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2002 or later, and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a booklet on spiritual experience and a booklet on emotional sobriety.
- The committee considered a suggestion that a service position of Grapevine Subscription Chairperson be adopted by A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada and concluded that there was no need for such a position.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹:

- After considerable discussion, the committee accepted the proposed draft Guidelines and Procedures for 2010 International Convention Site Selection with one minor revision. These draft Guidelines and Procedures were forwarded to this committee by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.
- The committee discussed a progress report on the International Conventions Inventory requested by the 1999 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee requests that all Conference members encourage their areas to discuss the need and purpose of International Conventions and to submit written reports of these discussions to the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee noted that this International Conventions Inventory is a general inventory of all International Conventions and not specifically the 2000 International Convention.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the proposed distribution plan and text for the 2000 International Convention Questionnaire.
- The committee reviewed and discussed the 2000 International Convention Budget.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee's progress report on the development of a pamphlet for

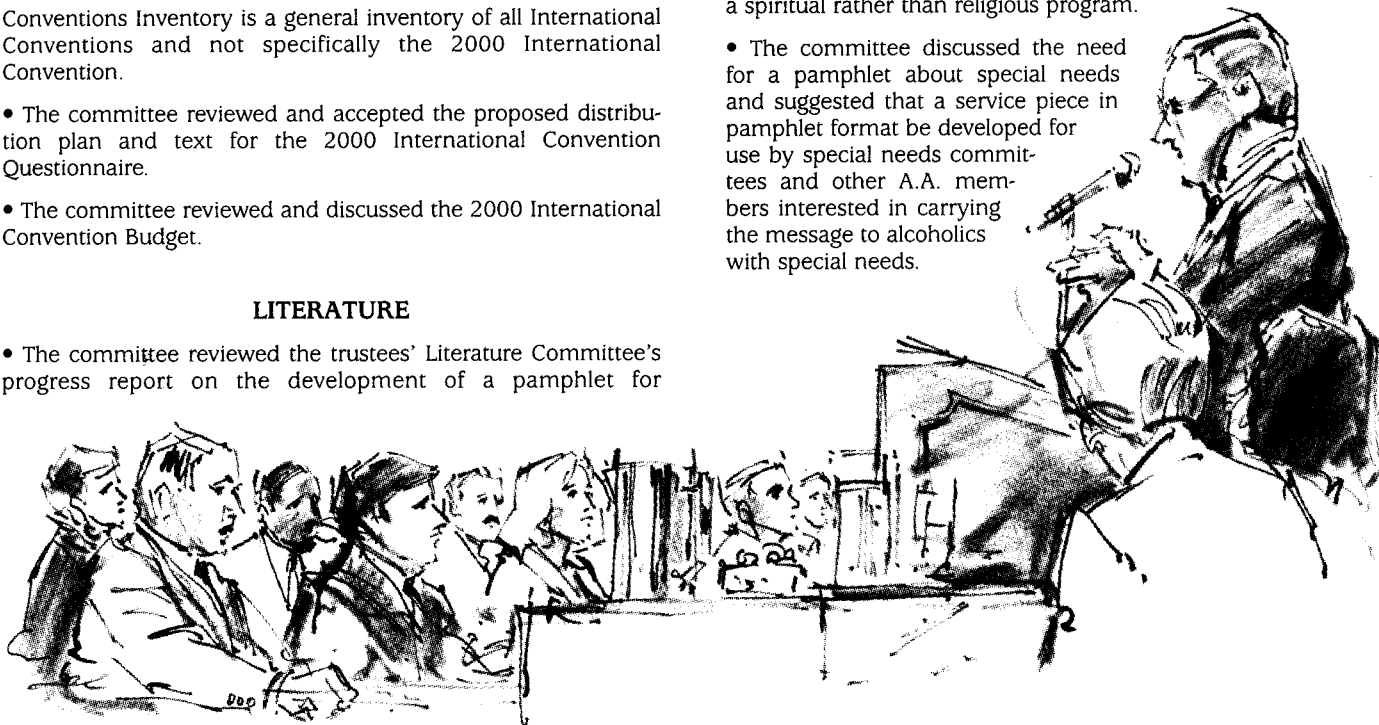
Black/African American alcoholics, expressed appreciation for the wide net cast to obtain stories and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the proposed pamphlet at the 2001 General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee's progress report on a pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living," expressed appreciation for the wide net cast to obtain stories and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the proposed pamphlet at the 2001 General Service Conference.
- The committee suggested that the pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living" be available in both standard size print and large print and that the latter be formatted to fit the literature racks used by most groups.
- The committee also suggested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider one price for both the standard type print and large print versions of the pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living."
- The committee appreciates the work of the delegates who responded to the special interest literature questionnaire and agreed that the results were inconclusive in terms of answering the question about whether there is a need for the continued development of special interest literature asked by the 1999 Conference Literature Committee for the following reasons:

- 1) The nature of the questions.
- 2) The timing of the survey.
- 3) Only 35 % of the delegates/delegate areas responded.

As a result of reviewing responses, it was noted that some of the special interest literature needs to be updated.

- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet for the non-believer or a pamphlet explaining that A.A. is a spiritual rather than a religious program and could not reach consensus regarding the need. If the trustees' Literature Committee proceeds to develop a pamphlet, it was suggested that the focus be on A.A. as a spiritual rather than religious program.
- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet about special needs and suggested that a service piece in pamphlet format be developed for use by special needs committees and other A.A. members interested in carrying the message to alcoholics with special needs.



POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to revise the "Composition" to reflect current procedures for Conference committee assignments.
- The request for an additional delegate area by Southern California Area 05 was considered and the committee took no action because they were unable to reach consensus.
- The committee strongly suggested that the 2001 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider revising the "Application for Additional Delegate Area" in order to ensure that adequate information is provided for evaluating future applications.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider a workshop on "Future Growth of the Conference" during the 2001 General Service Conference.
- The committee suggested that the 2001 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider developing guidelines for the use of personal computers by Conference members during the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the inclusion of text emphasizing Anonymity at the Level of the Internet in Public Information service material and welcomed the addition of this most valuable information.
- The committee considered the suggestion to remove Question #4 — regarding race, and decided to leave the question in the survey. The committee determined that the question is helpful to the Fellowship in discovering the degree of diversity and make-up of the membership, determining trends in diversity and ascertaining the need for future out-reach to groups where the numbers are smaller than the national averages.
- The committee suggested that the G.S.O. staff member serving as "special needs" liaison consider gathering local experience on the accessibility of A.A. meetings to members with "special needs." The committee further suggested that "special needs" information be added to the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.
- The committee requested that in preparing the 2004 Membership Survey Questionnaire consideration be given to the following suggestions:

Question 3 — Marital Status

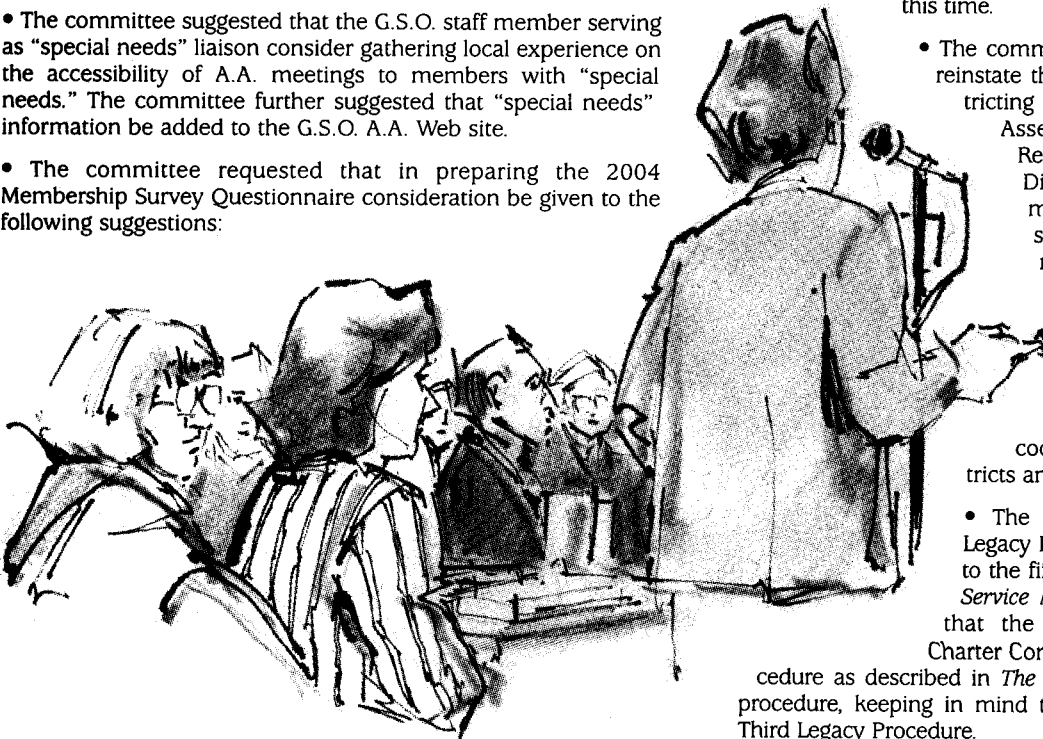
- Add a choice for those members who live in a domestic partnership, yet who are not married.

Question 12 — Employment Status

- Examine the list of choices to determine if the current listing offers those with a skilled trade a clear choice.
- The committee reviewed the 1999 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity and were encouraged by the growing effectiveness of this most valuable P.I. vehicle. The effectiveness the G.S.O. A.A. Web site's continued role in providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work was underlined.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that a sheet highlighting Public Information audiovisual materials be added to the Public Information Kit.
- The committee discussed the trustees' Report on the Posthumous Anonymity of the Co-founders and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue its discussion of the issue of our co-founders' anonymity and develop a coherent policy to be forwarded to the 2001 Conference Committee on Public Information for their consideration, in the hope that wider sharing on this issue will clarify this matter. The committee also requested that, pending a final policy resolution of this question, the G.S.O. Public Information Coordinator continue to make Conference-approved material available to the media.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the section "How I got interested in General Service" to Chapter Six: "The Delegate" and agreed that in order to maintain the continuity of the 1999-2000 *The A.A. Service Manual*, that adding "Personal Views" from a previous edition manual was not desirable at this time.
- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the sentence "The proposed redistricting should be approved by the area Assembly" in the section on Redistricting in Chapter Three: "The District and the DCM" and unanimously agreed that the sentence should not be reinstated. The committee felt that adding such a sentence was not consistent with the autonomy reflected in the Fourth Tradition and agreed that the section adequately stressed the importance of good communication and cooperation amongst groups, districts and areas.
- The committee discussed the Third Legacy Procedure specifically in reference to the fifth ballot as described in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee suggests that the 2001 Conference Report and Charter Committee review the fifth ballot procedure as described in *The A.A. Service Manual* to clarify the procedure, keeping in mind the 1984 Advisory Action on the Third Legacy Procedure.



TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed the Treatment Facilities Kit. The committee considered whether additional pamphlets might be helpful for those doing this service work, and concluded that the Kit contained complete information for local Treatment Facilities committees.

- The committee members shared about the Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts in their areas. A variety of contact methods were discussed, and it was noted that A.A. contacts are particularly important for clients in short-term facilities.

Concern was expressed about the inconsistency in Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts throughout the United States and Canada. The committee stressed that efforts to help alcoholics coming out of Treatment Facilities are vital whether done by committees named Hospitals and Institutions, Treatment Facilities, or Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact.

- Several committee members shared specific ways that local Treatment Facilities committees have obtained finances to purchase A.A. literature, including budgeting funds to purchase literature for Treatment Facilities committees, a "pink can" set out at meetings to collect spare change designated specifically for literature, and local service events.

- The committee requested that the Treatment Facilities staff person collect sharing from areas on formats used for institutional meetings for the purpose of possible inclusion in Treatment Facilities materials.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed at length the proposal that the selection of a regional trustee be made by delegates of the region only and unanimously agreed that no change be made to the current procedures at this time.

COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The Correctional Facilities Kit be designated as service material, and that the contents of the Correctional Facilities Kit not be changed prior to review by the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee; however, literature catalogs, A.A. guidelines, Box 4-5-9, and service material contained in the kit would be the current versions.

FINANCE

- To adjust the General Service Board's Reserve Fund, the trustees continue the policy to consider other projects and ways of carry



ing the message such as, additional free literature, foreign translations, and increased discounts before adjusting selling prices. The committee felt this was necessary to clarify trustees' options during the budget process.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The time frame for the 2010 International Convention be expanded from July 4th weekend, 2010 to May 1 through September 15, 2010. Expanding the time frame provides flexibility to the bidding cities.

LITERATURE

- Prior to being asked to vote approval of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, all Conference members be given the titles and a brief synopsis of both the new stories and those stories carried forward from the Third Edition. The synopsis of the stories will be similar to the brief descriptions found in the table of contents of the Third Edition.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- That the Grapevine not move forward with a Web site message board, forum, or other online meeting format until this issue can be fully discussed by the 51st General Service Conference and go through the committee and Conference process. **(Not approved)**

- That in selection of regional trustees, two-thirds of the voters be the delegates from the region involved and one-third be divided between the Conference Committee on Trustees and the Trustees' Nominating Committee. **(Not approved)**

- That all work on the Black/African American pamphlet cease as it does not promote unity or our common welfare. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

(Note: Two Floor Actions from "Delegates Only Meeting" were withdrawn.)